

Dos and Don'ts.

Category	Dos	Don'ts
Schema Selection & Content	Include multiple schema types on a single page if they accurately reflect the content, such as Article, Video, and Organization. Use the Organization schema for known entities to build authority and help Google understand site associations. Use Article schema for evergreen content and NewsArticle for recent, time-sensitive events. For Local Business schema , ensure the address matches Google Maps exactly and include accurate latitude and longitude . Ensure product schema includes SKU, offers, and return policies to avoid critical errors in search reports.	Do not use the Home Page URL as an item in Breadcrumb schema ; it is technically incorrect according to official documentation. Avoid repeating the same FAQ schema across every page of a website, as Google may view this as an abuse of the system. Do not use fake reviews or inaccurate product names; product names that are too long can trigger "invalid string length" warnings.
Implementation	Test your schema code using the Rich Result Testing Tool both before and after adding it to your site. In custom-coded websites, place the schema script in the <head> section, ideally just before the closing tag. If using WordPress , utilize plugins like "Schema and Structure Data for WP" to add custom JSON-LD. Always purge your website cache after implementing new schema to ensure testing tools see the updated data.	Do not ignore warnings in testing tools even if they aren't "errors," as they often point to missing fields like shipping details or merchant policies. Do not include a URL for the final item in a Breadcrumb schema; only the name is required since the user is already on that page.
Search Console Maintenance	Prioritize fixing "Invalid" (red) errors in Search Console Enhancement Reports, as these prevent rich results from appearing. Use tools like ChatGPT to help identify specific missing elements in your HTML code if the error reasons are unclear. Verify the factual accuracy of your schema content regularly, as mismatches between schema data and page content can lead to manual penalties .	Do not click "Validate Fix" until you have actually resolved the issue across all affected pages. Do not assume that the presence of a "Snippet" in the report means a rich result is definitely showing; Google decides this dynamically in the search results.
Core Web Vitals (Performance)	Set a "min-height" (minimum height) in CSS for layout elements to prevent Cumulative Layout Shift (CLS) . Aim for a Largest Contentful Paint (LCP) of under 2.5 seconds . Target an Interaction to Next Paint (INP) of under 200 milliseconds by keeping the page light and efficient. Prioritize Field Data (real-world user experience) over Lab Data when analyzing performance, as Google uses real user metrics for ranking.	Don't rely solely on image compression ; while helpful, it only solves a small fraction of performance issues. Do not allow layout elements to "shift" or jump after the page begins loading, as a CLS score above 0.1 is considered a failure. Don't ignore the "above the fold" content, as this is where the Largest Contentful Paint is measured.

What need to be done?

1. Advanced Schema Data Strategy

To help Google's systems understand your content, you should implement the following specific practices:

- **Identify Multiple Schema Types:** Do not limit a page to one schema. For example, a news article page should include NewsArticle (for recent events) or Article (for evergreen content), plus Organization (for the publisher), Breadcrumb, Image, and Video schema if applicable.
- **Implement "Supercharged" Local Business Schema:** If mentioning a local business, ensure the name matches the business exactly and the address precisely follows the Google Maps listing. You should "supercharge" this data by manually adding properties like founding date, payment methods, and service area (using IDs like Wikipedia URLs for specific cities) to establish stronger semantic connections.
- **Follow Specific Item Rules:**
 - **Breadcrumbs:** Never include the Home Page as a list item in Breadcrumb schema, and do not include a URL for the final item (the current page the user is on).
 - **Products:** You must include a unique identifier (SKU), offers (price/currency), and availability (InStock/OutOfStock).
 - **Videos:** A thumbnail URL is mandatory; without it, Google will not index the video as a specific video type.
 - **FAQs:** Avoid repeating the same FAQ schema across multiple pages, as this can lead to system abuse warnings.
- **Verify Content Accuracy:** Beyond technical validity, your schema data must match the page content exactly. Factual mismatches (e.g., a "Technical Writer" job title in schema vs. "SEO" on the page) can trigger manual penalties.

2. Technical Implementation & Validation

- **Placement:** For custom-coded sites, paste the JSON-LD script in the `<head>` section, ideally just before the closing tag.
- **WordPress Tools:** Use a plugin like "Schema and Structure Data for WP" to add custom JSON-LD to specific pages.
- **Validation Workflow:** Always test code in the Rich Result Testing Tool. If using a cache plugin, purge the cache after adding schema to ensure testing tools see the updated data.
- **Search Console Maintenance:** Prioritize fixing "Invalid" (red) errors in Search Console Enhancement Reports, as these prevent rich results from appearing. If the error is unclear, you can use ChatGPT to help identify missing fields in your HTML.

3. Core Web Vitals (Performance) Optimization

Google expects your website to be fast and stable. Focus on these three metrics:

- **Largest Contentful Paint (LCP):** Target a load time of under 2.5 seconds for the largest element (image, text, or video) visible "above the fold" (without scrolling). If an element is too slow, a "match-fixing" trick is to break the element into smaller parts (e.g., splitting a long text block) so the LCP moves to a faster, smaller element.
- **Cumulative Layout Shift (CLS):** Target a score below 0.1. To prevent content from "jumping" during load, set a "min-height" (minimum height) in your CSS for elements like ads or product feeds to reserve space before they load.
- **Interaction to Next Paint (INP):** Ensure your page reacts to user clicks within 200 milliseconds. Achieve this by keeping the page lightweight and ensuring no heavy background processes are running when the page is interactive.
- **Field vs. Lab Data:** Prioritize Field Data (real-world user metrics) in PageSpeed Insights, as this is what Google uses to evaluate your site's helpfulness for ranking.

How to do it ?

1. Generating and Supercharging Schema Data

You should first identify all relevant schema types for a page. A single page can (and often should) have multiple types, such as NewsArticle, Organization, Video, and Breadcrumb.

- Breadcrumbs: Do not include the Home Page as the first item; the list should start from the first sub-level. For the final item (the current page), include only the name, not the URL.
- Product Schema: Ensure you include the SKU (unique identifier), Price, Currency, and Availability (InStock/OutOfStock).
- Video Schema: A thumbnail URL is mandatory. You must also provide the Content URL (the actual video file location) and the Embed URL (the URL used to embed the video on other pages).
- Supercharging Local Business: Manually add properties not found in standard generators, such as foundingDate, paymentAccepted (e.g., Credit Card, UPI), and serviceArea. To make the service area authoritative, use the Wikipedia URL ID for the specific city or state.

2. Implementation Methods

The sources recommend two primary ways to add this data to your site:

- Custom Coded Websites: Paste the JSON-LD script into the `<head>` section of your HTML, ideally right before the closing `</head>` tag.
- WordPress/CMS: Use a plugin such as "Schema and Structure Data for WP". This allows you to paste custom JSON-LD code into a specific "Custom Schema" box for individual pages.
- Post-Implementation: Always purge your website cache (HTML, CSS, and JS) after adding schema so that search engines and testing tools can see the updated data immediately.

3. Validation and Troubleshooting

- Testing: Use the Rich Result Testing Tool to verify your code before and after it goes live.
- Search Console Reports: Monitor the Enhancement Reports in Google Search Console. Prioritize fixing "Invalid" (red) errors, as these prevent rich results from appearing.
- Factual Accuracy: Ensure the information in your schema (e.g., job titles or business names) matches the visible text on the page exactly to avoid manual penalties.

4. Optimizing Core Web Vitals

To pass Google's performance standards, you must optimize three key metrics:

- Largest Contentful Paint (LCP): Target a load time under 2.5 seconds. If an element (like a large text block) is loading too slowly, you can "hack" the result by breaking the element into smaller parts so the LCP moves to a faster-loading element.
- Cumulative Layout Shift (CLS): Target a score below 0.1. To stop elements from "jumping" during load, set a `min-height` (minimum height) in your CSS for dynamic elements like product feeds or ads to reserve their space on the page.
- Interaction to Next Paint (INP): Target a response time under 200 milliseconds. Achieve this by keeping the page lightweight and ensuring no heavy background processes are running when the user interacts with the site.
- Data Focus: Prioritize Field Data (real-world user experience) over Lab Data, as Google uses real user metrics for ranking

Common mistakes and solutions.

1. Breadcrumb Schema Mistakes

- **Mistake: Including the Home Page.** Approximately 80–90% of websites incorrectly include the home page as the first item in their breadcrumb schema. Official documentation states it is not required to include the top-level path or domain as a list item.

- **Solution:** Skip the home page URL in the schema markup and start the list from the first category or sub-page.

- **Mistake: Providing a URL for the final item.** Many implementations include a link for the page the user is already on.

- **Solution:** The final item in a breadcrumb trail should only include the **name**, not the URL, because the user is already at that destination.

2. Content Accuracy and Policy Violations

- **Mistake: Repetitive FAQ Schema.** A common "abuse" of the system is repeating the same set of FAQs across hundreds or thousands of pages.

- **Solution:** While you can repeat the text on the website, only apply the **FAQ schema markup to a single page** to avoid being flagged by Google.

- **Mistake: Factual Mismatches.** Entering data into schema that does not match the visible content (e.g., listing a "Technical Writer" job in schema but "SEO" on the page).

- **Solution:** Ensure strict accuracy. Mismatches between schema and page content can lead to **manual penalties**.

3. Missing Mandatory Fields

- **Mistake: Missing Video Thumbnails.** Failing to provide a thumbnail URL for video schema.

- **Solution:** A **thumbnail URL is mandatory**; without it, Google will not index the video as a video-type result.

- **Mistake: Missing Product Identifiers.** Skipping the **SKU** or **Offer** fields in product schema.

- **Solution:** You must include a unique identifier (SKU) and offer details (price, currency, availability) to avoid critical "Invalid" errors in Search Console.

- **Mistake: Missing Job Organization.** Omitting the `hiringOrganization` field in job posting schema.

- **Solution:** This is a required field; the schema is considered invalid if the hiring organization is not specified.

4. Search Console & Implementation Errors

- **Mistake: Premature Validation.** Clicking the "Validate Fix" button in Search Console before actually resolving the issue across all affected URLs.

- **Solution:** Resolve the error on every page and verify it with the **Rich Result Testing Tool** before requesting validation.

- **Mistake: Ignoring Cache.** Testing schema changes without clearing the website cache.

- **Solution:** Always **purge your website cache** (HTML, CSS, and JS) after implementing schema to ensure testing tools see the updated data.

5. Core Web Vitals (Performance) Errors

- **Mistake: Relying Solely on Image Compression.** Thinking that reducing image sizes will fully solve speed issues.

- **Solution:** Image optimization typically only provides **25% of the solution**; the remaining 75% involves fixing server response times and layout stability.

- **Mistake: Layout Shifting (CLS).** Allowing elements to "jump" or shift as the page loads, which occurs when elements like images or ads load without reserved space.

- **Solution:** Set a **min-height** (minimum height) in your CSS for dynamic sections to reserve space before the content renders.

- **Mistake: Slow Largest Contentful Paint (LCP).** Failing to load the largest "above the fold" element within 2.5 seconds.

- **Solution:** If an element is too large to load quickly, use a **"match-fixing" approach** by breaking the large element into smaller pieces (e.g., splitting a long text block) so the LCP moves to a faster-loading element